MAS
Al Maaref American School
مدرسة المعارف الأمريكية

AL MAAREF AMERICAN SCHOOL

MAS Refund Policy

ACADEMIC YEAR

2026 – 2027

1. Purpose and Scope

This Refund Policy outlines the conditions under which tuition and fees paid to Al Maaref American School may be refunded. It ensures transparency, compliance with Knowledge and Human Development Authority (KHDA) regulations, and fairness to both the school and families.

2. Definitions

- **Application Fee:** a one-time, non-refundable-by-default fee charged to process a new student's application and assessment.
- **Registration Deposit:** a payment made to confirm a new student's enrolment once a formal offer of a place has been made and accepted.
- **Re-Registration Deposit:** a payment made by parents of currently enrolled students to secure their child's place for the following academic year.
- **Withdrawal Date:** the date specified by the parent on a formal written withdrawal request, from which all refund calculations are made.
- **Withdrawal Form:** a document issued by MAS confirming the official withdrawal date and that financial obligations for the period of attendance have been met.
- **Transfer Certificate:** a document confirming a student is eligible to transfer to another KHDA-permitted school and that all outstanding fees have been settled.

3. Application Fees

MAS may charge an application fee of up to AED 500 to process the application of a new student. This fee covers standard assessment costs and is separate from tuition fees; it cannot be deducted from tuition fees.

3.1 Refund of the Application Fee

- If MAS makes a formal offer of a place and the parent chooses not to accept it, the application fee is non-refundable.

4. Registration Fees and Deposit

MAS may only request a registration deposit after a formal offer of enrolment has been made and accepted by the parent. The registration deposit cannot exceed 10% of the annual tuition fee for the relevant grade level.

The registration deposit is deducted from the tuition fees due for the first term of enrolment; it is an advance payment toward tuition, not an additional cost.

4.1 Refund of the Registration Deposit

- Refundable in full if the parent formally notifies MAS in writing at least 60 calendar days before the student's start date.

- Non-refundable if the parent formally notifies MAS less than 60 calendar days before the student's start date.

5. Re-Registration Fees and Deposit

Parents of currently enrolled students may be asked to pay a re-registration deposit to secure their child's place for the following academic year. This deposit cannot exceed 5% of the annual tuition fee or AED 500, whichever is higher, and is deducted from tuition fees due for the following academic year.

5.1 Timing of Collection

- As a September-start school, MAS will not collect the re-registration deposit until after the end of the spring break, and the payment deadline will not be set earlier than 1 May.

5.2 Refund of the Re-Registration Deposit

- Refundable in full if the parent formally notifies MAS in writing at least 60 calendar days before the start of the following academic year.
- Non-refundable if the parent formally notifies MAS less than 60 calendar days before the start of the following academic year.

5.3 Missed Deadline

If the re-registration deposit is not paid by the stated deadline and the student does not enrol for the following academic year, MAS will not seek payment of that deposit at a later date. However, MAS cannot guarantee the student's place if the deposit is not paid on time.

6. Withdrawal Procedure

- Parents must complete and submit a formal written withdrawal request to the School's administration.
- The date specified on the withdrawal request becomes the official Withdrawal Date and is recorded on the Withdrawal Form. All refund calculations are made from this date.
- The Withdrawal Date is not the same as the student's last day of attendance. Being listed on the School's register counts as active enrolment regardless of attendance, and fees continue to accrue until a formal withdrawal request is submitted.
- A student's absence from school, on its own, does not constitute withdrawal and does not trigger a refund.
- The Withdrawal Date cannot be backdated to a date earlier than the date the written request is submitted.

7. Tuition Fee Refunds

Refunds of tuition fees are calculated on a term-by-term basis from the Withdrawal Date recorded on the Withdrawal Certificate, as follows:

Duration of Enrolment in the Term	Tuition Fee Deducted
Before the academic year begins	No tuition deduction (only the registration/re-registration deposit may be retained if withdrawal is notified less than 60 calendar days before the start date)
Enrolled for two weeks or less in the term	One (1) month's tuition fee is deducted; the balance is refunded
Enrolled for more than two weeks but up to one month in the term	Two (2) months' tuition fee is deducted; the balance is refunded
Enrolled for more than one month in the term	The full term's tuition fee is retained; no refund is due for that term

This applies whether tuition fees were paid in full for the term/year or by instalment.

8. Tuition Fee Payment Schedule

MAS collects tuition fees using one of the following two methods:

Payment Option	Instalment	Maximum Share of Annual Tuition Fee
Three termly instalments	Term 1	Up to 40%
	Term 2	Up to 30%
	Term 3	Up to 30%

9. Mandatory and Optional Service Fees

9.1 Mandatory Services

Fees for mandatory services that are regulated and approved by KHDA are fully refundable if paid prior to the start of the academic year and the service is subsequently not required or not delivered.

9.2 Transportation Fees

- Transportation fees are refunded on a pro-rata basis, calculated from the start of the month following the Withdrawal Date.
- No partial-month refunds are provided for transportation.

- Transportation fees are non-refundable in the event of distance learning, temporary school closures, or any period during which students receive remote instruction.
- Transportation fees are refunded as per KHDA guidelines and policy.

9.3 Other Fees

- Books, uniforms, and external examination fees are strictly non-refundable once purchased or processed.
- Activity fees or field trip payments are refundable only if the activity has not yet taken place.
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10. Transfer and Withdrawal Form

- A Withdrawal Form is issued when a student leaves MAS without immediately transferring to another school. It records the official Withdrawal Date and confirms that financial obligations for the period of attendance have been met.
- A Transfer Certificate confirms that a student is eligible to transfer to another school, into a grade compliant with current legislation, and that all outstanding fees have been settled.
- MAS may withhold a Transfer Certificate only where outstanding fees have not been paid in full. Once all fees are settled, the certificate is issued promptly and at no additional charge; no processing fee will be levied.

11. Service Disruption

11.1 Voluntary Suspension or Reduction of Service

- MAS will notify parents in writing as soon as a decision to suspend or reduce services is made, including the reason and expected duration.
- Tuition fees remain payable for any period during which the service was available and delivered, including via distance learning or another KHDA-approved method.

11.2 Closure Due to Circumstances Beyond Anyone's Control

- Fees remain payable for every day the service was available and delivered, including through KHDA-approved distance learning.
- A parent's decision not to engage with available distance learning does not, on its own, constitute grounds for withholding or reducing fees. Concerns about the quality of distance learning should be raised through the School's internal complaints process, and fees remain payable in full while any such complaint is being resolved.
- Fees for any period after the service could no longer be delivered at all are held on the parent's behalf as credit; they are not lost.

- A government-enforced closure does not affect the School's entitlement to open registration and collect re-registration deposits for the following academic year through digital or remote means.

12. Circumstances Beyond the Control of Either Party

In the event of a government-enforced closure, registration and re-registration deposits remain subject to refund consideration, in addition to the standard provisions above. Personal circumstances, such as a change of mind, relocation, or financial difficulty, do not qualify a deposit for refund under this provision.

13. Refund Processing

- Refunds are processed only after all outstanding dues to MAS have been cleared.
- Approved refunds are paid by bank transfer or cheque, in accordance with KHDA regulations, within a reasonable processing period from the date all outstanding dues are cleared.

14. Disputes

Any dispute regarding fees or refunds should first be raised with MAS through the School's internal complaints process. All internal resolution steps must be completed and documented before a matter is escalated further.

If the dispute remains unresolved once the internal process has concluded, either party may refer the matter to KHDA through its official channels. KHDA may request documentary evidence from both parties, and MAS will cooperate fully with any review.

15. Policy Compliance and Review

This Policy is issued in accordance with KHDA regulations governing fees and refunds at private schools in Dubai and is subject to review and amendment as required by KHDA or other governing authorities. The current version applies to the 2026–2027 academic year and will be reviewed ahead of each new academic year or sooner if regulations change.

MAS administration